

the breakout comes, volume can rise substantially and usually does, but heavy breakout day volume is not a prerequisite.

Identification Challenges

By now you may feel comfortable with correctly identifying an ascending triangle. However, there are some situations that may fool people new to the pattern. [Figure 64.2](#) shows the first one. Cover up the right half of the figure and ask yourself if what you see on the left looks like an ascending triangle.

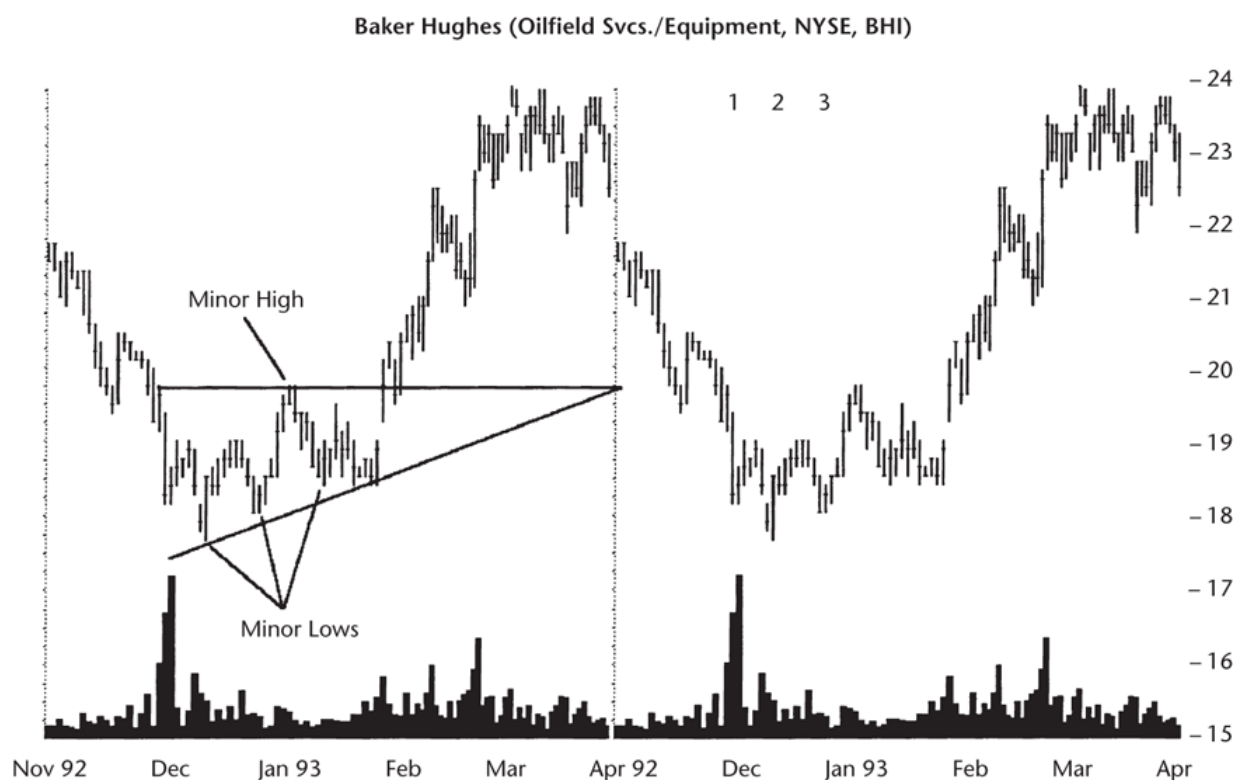


Figure 64.2 Two views of an incorrectly identified ascending triangle. What looks like an ascending triangle on the left is not a valid triangle on the right. The three downward spikes in December, identified by the numbers near the top of the figure, mark a head-and-shoulders bottom with a horizontal neckline, not a triangle.

The horizontal line, drawn to rest on top of the central peak, extends to the left and right until it intersects price. Although the lower trendline has